Atezolizumab 1200 mg · every 3 weeks · lung cancer

Atezolizumab 1200 mg is given by intravenous infusion on Day 1 every 3 weeks (21 days). The first infusion lasts about 60 minutes; later infusions may last 30 minutes if tolerated. The visit includes checks and preparation. This protocol also offers a separately prescribed 1875 mg injection under the skin of the thigh over about 7 minutes every 3 weeks. The intravenous (IV) and under-skin doses are not interchangeable milligram for milligram. Adjuvant: maximum 12 months. Advanced non-small-cell lung cancer (NSCLC) and extensive-stage small-cell lung cancer (ES-SCLC) maintenance: until progression or unacceptable toxicity. ES-SCLC requires completed induction; this suite contains no induction chemotherapy.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Hormones / nervous system

Atezolizumab

Severe headache, confusion, weakness, dizziness or marked thirst need prompt advice.

2 Lungs

Atezolizumab

New cough or breathlessness can signal inflammation or another urgent cause.

3 Heart

Atezolizumab

Chest pain, racing heartbeat or fainting needs urgent assessment.

4 Liver

Atezolizumab

Yellow eyes/skin or dark urine may signal inflammation; tests also check the liver.

5 Kidneys

Atezolizumab

Report much less urine, new swelling or a change in kidney tests.

6 Bowel

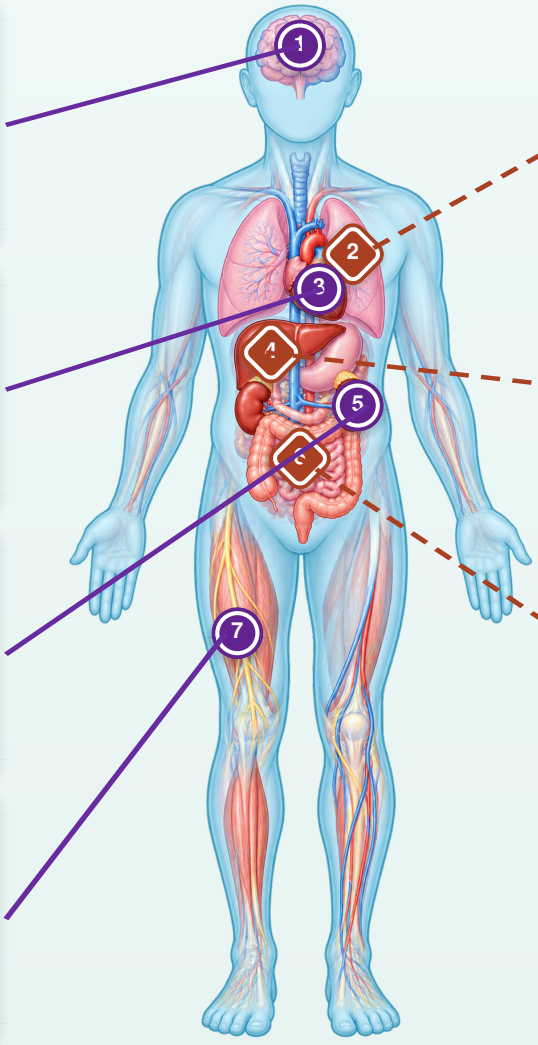
Atezolizumab

New or persistent diarrhoea, blood in stools or severe tummy pain needs urgent advice.

7 Skin / muscles

Atezolizumab

Spreading rash, blisters, severe weakness or muscle pain needs prompt review.



Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Contact the oncology team immediately for new or worsening breathlessness, chest pain, persistent diarrhoea, severe tummy pain, yellow skin/eyes, much less urine, severe headache, marked weakness, confusion, unusual thirst or passing much more urine, or a spreading/blistering rash. For severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or other immediately dangerous symptoms, seek emergency care. Do not wait for the next infusion.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Atezolizumab

- Immune inflammation of lungs, bowel, liver, kidneys, hormone glands, skin, heart and nervous system
- Infusion reactions
- Some effects need steroids, hospital care or long-term hormone replacement
- Effects may start after the final dose

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Sickness medicines

Atezolizumab alone has a minimal risk of causing sickness. Routine anti-sickness medicines or infusion premedicines are not usually needed; your team can prescribe symptom relief if required.

Immune alert card

Carry your alert card during treatment and afterwards. Show it when seeking urgent care; symptoms can be mistaken for an infection or an ordinary stomach upset.

Hormones and steroids

Some immune effects need steroids or hormone replacement. Follow the prescribed plan and do not stop steroids suddenly. Ask for help if symptoms worsen or you cannot take essential medicines.

Pregnancy and breastfeeding

Discuss pregnancy, fertility and breastfeeding before treatment. Use effective contraception during treatment and for at least 5 months after the last dose. Breastfeeding requires a specialist decision; contact your team promptly if pregnancy occurs.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00544/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.